

3 STEPS TO GREAT IMPROV!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #131

Improvisation is all about coming up with great melodies on the fly. Even for drummers, whose main tools are rhythm and texture, melodic playing is key. So, where do these fabulous we are supposed to be playing come from? Three steps, brother!

- 1) Learn and memorize jazz songs. They are the greatest jazz melodies ever played. always be learning a new song.
- 2) Bring licks and vocabulary you already know INTO this new song. This reminds you of, and helps you review the melodies and devices you already know. These familiar licks and devices also help you sound good on the new song that you are still learning. They help teach you the new song.
- 3) Take a very short bit OUT of the new song. This is a new lick or device for you. Practice it and learn it. You will bring it into the NEXT song you begin to learn.

Step #1 - "Billies Bounce" by Charlie Parker



The first few measures of the song I am learning.

Step #2 - My old lick



A lick that I happen to know, that I will work into my new song (Billies Bounce). This is a lick that I learned years ago the Monk song "Blue Monk."

Step #3 - My NEW lick, from Billies Bounce



This is the lick that I picked from Billies Bounce. I kept it short and concise, and made sure it had some "tension & release" in it.